

State's Solar Summary

Massachusetts (Smart Program): Available to National Grid, Eversource, and Unitil Customers. Net metering available, to ensure the customer gets both programs, Max system size design for 14.5 kW dc system.

- **Smart program** is a first come first served, limited residential capacity. If the application is approved, the customer gets a fixed incentive per kWh of production for 10 years. Incentive value is broken up through utilities and distinct blocks. Once the block is full, the smart program opens the next block with a lower value for the incentive.
- **Net Metering:** Customers will get a 1:1 credit value for their excess electric production. The Max system size to qualify is 14.5 kW DC, but customers can offset more than 100% of their last 12 previous months' electric consumption. Credits roll over month to month, credits can only be used for future use and the customer will NEVER get a check for their excess solar at the end of the year. Credits are only meant to be used for future electric use.
- **Residential Renewable Energy Income Tax Credit:** The 15% state solar tax credit is available for purchased home solar systems in Massachusetts. (Max. \$1,000 state tax reduction.)
- **Solar Installation Property Tax Exemption:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from a home solar system.
- **Home Solar Project Sales Tax Exemption:** 6.25% home solar system state sales tax exemption.

Rhode Island (F.I.T)

- **RE Growth Program:** Residential customers who choose to participate in this program will receive 28.75 cents for each kilowatt-hour (kWh) their solar panel system generates for the first 15 years of their system.
- **Net metering** is also available for customers who would not like to participate in the RE Growth Program. Max system offset is 125% of the last 35 months of electrical consumption. Max System size is 36.25 kW DC, with no restriction on the number of homes under the net metering program. Credits roll over month to month, if credits remain they'll be credited as a dollar credit for their account, credits will continue to roll over until used on a bill, a check will not be issued for excess credits.
- **Renewable Energy Sales Tax Exemption:** 7% home solar system state sales tax exemption.
- **Solar Investment Property Tax Exemption:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from the Rhode Island solar panel system

New York:

- **NY State Solar Energy System Equipment Tax Credit**

The 25% state solar tax credit is available for purchased home solar systems in New York. Tax Credit are twofold: first, you don't have to purchase your system to claim the credit (i.e. it applies to you even if you went solar with a lease or PPA), and second, if your tax liability isn't large enough to claim the entire credit in the first year, you can roll it over into the next year.

- **Solar Electric Generating System Tax Abatement (SEGS)**
- **Property tax exemption** on the added home value from a solar system.
- **Home Solar Project Sales Tax Exemption:** 4% home solar system state sales tax exemption.
- **NY-Sun Megawatt (MW) Block Program:** Up to \$1,000 for every kilowatt (kW) of solar power installed.

Illinois

- **Solar Renewable Energy Credits (SRECs):** Homeowners may apply to be compensated for the production their solar system creates per kilowatt-hour (kWh) for 15 years. At the moment SREC's are not available anymore, waiting for new legislation, ABP program was available for a limited time on a first come first served basis until Fund for the ABP program ran out.
- If you're a **ComEd customer** and install solar on your business, you're eligible for \$250 per kilowatt (kW) of installed solar power. To receive the rebate, your solar panel system cannot be larger than 2,000 kW in capacity.
- **Net-Metering**
- **Solar Energy System Property Tax Incentive:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from the rooftop solar system.

New Jersey:

- **Solar Renewable Energy Credits (SRECs):** Homeowners that produce their own electricity will receive compensation per kilowatt-hour (kWh) produced by the system. for 15 years (Varies by market value.)
- **Solar Investment Property Tax Exemption:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from the rooftop solar system.
- **Solar Panel System Sales Tax Exemption:** 6.625% home solar system state sales tax exemption.
- **Net Metering**

California

- **Self-Generation Incentive Program (SGIP):** Rebate for buying and installing a solar battery along with a rooftop panel system. Varies by utility and storage capacity.
- **Solar Energy System Property Tax Exclusion:** Property tax exclusion on the added home value from the rooftop solar system.
- **Local Utility Company Rebates** (San Francisco and Sacramento only): Cash incentives for installing solar panels in California. Varies by the utility.

Arizona

- **Arizona Residential Solar Energy Tax Credit:** The 25% state solar tax credit is available for purchased home solar systems in Arizona. (Max. \$1,000 personal income tax reduction.)
- **Energy Equipment Property Tax Exemption:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from the rooftop panel system.
- **Solar Equipment Sales Tax Exemption:** 5.6% home solar system state sales tax exemption.

Nevada

- **NV Energy Residential Energy Storage Incentives:** NV Energy customers could save money if they add a new home battery to their rooftop solar panel system
- **NV Energy:** NV Energy customers will receive credits worth 95% of the retail rate of electricity for their excess solar production. As more property owners install solar, credits available for new customers will decline in value. For every 80 megawatts (MW) of solar installed, credit values for new customers will decline by 7%, with a minimum credit value of 75% of the retail rate.
- **Valley Electric Association:** If you live in Valley Electric Association's service territory, you can get credited for your solar electricity at the same rate you would pay the utility. This means that, if your solar energy system is the right size, you can cover all of your electricity use for the entire year.

New Mexico

- **New Solar Market Development Income Tax Credit:** The 10% state solar tax credit is available for purchased home solar systems in New Mexico. (Max. \$6,000 tax reduction.)
- **Solar Renewable Energy Credits (SRECs):** El Paso Electric Company (EPE) and Public Service Company of New Mexico (PNM) customers can get compensation per kilowatt-hour (kWh) produced by their systems.
- **Solar Energy System Property Tax Exemption:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from the rooftop solar system.
- **Solar Installation Sales Tax Exemption:** 5.125% home solar system state sales tax exemption.
- **New Mexico Sustainable Building Tax Credit (SBTC):** A tax credit for newly constructed homes with solar panels. (2,000 sq. ft cap.) The New Mexico state government will credit you on your taxes if you install solar as part of your sustainable building efforts on your home. In order to qualify, your home needs to be certified sustainable by the U.S. Green Building Council, and the value of the credit is determined by your certification level. You could earn as much as \$6.50 per square foot for having a sustainable solar home!
- **El Paso electric renewable energy certificate purchase program:** If you're a customer of El Paso Electric Company, you can earn extra income from your solar panel system by participating in their renewable energy certificate purchase program. El Paso Electric will pay you \$0.02 per kilowatt-hour of electricity generated by your solar panels, which means more cash in your pocket and bigger solar savings.

Utah

Homeowner's that purchase or finance a solar system for their home can claim 25 percent of your total equipment and installation costs, up to \$1,600.

Net Metering is also available to Utah residents

Ohio:

State-sponsored interest rate reductions

The state has also created the **Energy Conservation for Ohioans (ECO-Link)** Program to make it less expensive for you to finance your solar energy system. All you have to do is successfully apply for the program and you will receive up to a 3 percent interest rate reduction on your bank loans, for up to seven years

- Max system size for Market 36.20 kW
- Max offset is 120%
- Duke energy max offset 100%

Colorado:

Property Tax Exemption for Residential Renewable Energy Equipment: Property tax exemption that excludes the added value of a solar panel system from the home's value for tax purposes in Colorado.

Sales and Use Tax Exemption for Renewable Energy Equipment: 2.9% to 11.2% home solar system sales tax exemption.

Local Utility Company Incentives and Solar Rebates: Cash incentives for the purchase of new rooftop solar panels. (Varies by utility and system size)

Xcel Energy Solar Rewards Program: Compensation per kilowatt-hour (kWh) produced by the system.

Texas:

TXU Energy Renewable Buyback Plan: Bill credits for the excess solar power a home solar panel installation creates in Texas. (Must live in a service area)

Solar Energy System Property Tax Exemption: Property tax exemption on the added home value from installed solar panels in Texas.

Local Utility Company Solar Rebates: Rebate to reduce solar's up-front cost or after the system's installation in Texas. (Varies by utility)

Wisconsin:

- **Sales tax incentive:** which exempts you from paying sales tax on your solar equipment, **Property tax incentive:** which exempts you from paying property taxes on any additional value solar adds to your home.

If you're installing a solar energy system on your home in Wisconsin, you're likely eligible for a **rebate from Focus on Energy**. Regardless of the size of your solar panel system and total project costs, you can get a flat **\$500 rebate to help decrease the permitting and interconnection costs associated with installing your solar panel system**, thanks to **net metering** in Wisconsin, you can send your extra solar energy back to the grid in exchange for credits on your utility bill.

Missouri:

Columbia Water & Light can get a payment of up to 625\$ per kilowatt (kW) of solar power generation capacity (up to 10kW). Additional rebates are available for larger system sizes as well.

Kansas City Power & Light: Solar rebate, Net metered solar households supplied by Kansas City Power & Light can receive a rebate payment of up to \$1 per watt of solar power installed on their home. The payment rates of this rebate program vary based on your application date.

Empire District Electric: Customers are eligible for a major solar rebate. Depending on the solar installation date and rebate application date, customers in the utility's territory can receive a solar rebate of up to \$2/W.

Ameren: eligible for a rebate from your utility when you install a solar panel system. Rebates values vary based on the size of your system and the type of installation: customers can receive \$0.25/watt upfront for installing solar panels – for an average 8 kilowatt(kW) system, that comes out to an extra \$2,000 in savings. The incentive is capped at 25 kW for residential customers, and 150 kW for commercial or industrial customers.

Solar property tax exemption: All solar homeowners in Missouri are exempt from property tax increases that result from installing solar panels on their homes.

Mississippi:

Mississippi is one of only six states in the nation without statewide net metering standards in place. Net metering remains completely at the discretion of the utility companies. That's a raw deal for Mississippi homeowners, unless you happen to live in the TVA service area, it might be difficult to figure out how your panels will affect your electricity bill.

Here's how Mississippi Power refers to its net metering policy: "the rate paid for electricity placed on the grid by a net metered customer is 2.5 cents/kWh above the company's avoided-cost rate" which "currently ranges from 2.29 to 3.62 cents/kWh." (at the time of this writing; late 2020).

Every 15 minutes, Mississippi Power will determine how much solar energy your system sent to the grid and credit you about 5.5 cents/kWh for it. They'll happily charge you an average of 7.5 cents/kWh for the energy you buy from them when the sun isn't shining.

Florida

- **Solar System Property Tax Exemption:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from the rooftop solar system.
- **Home Solar System Sales Tax Exemption:** 6% home solar system state sales tax exemption.
- **Net metering** available at 1:1 ratio for FLP and Duke Energy Customers

Georgia:

- **Net metering:** Available in Georgia Power, and Duke Energy in GA. In GA there are also EMC's, Research EMC's policies about their solar programs. EMCs have a high monthly customer service charge and usually charge a solar charge for homeowners that want to have solar systems installed. Best practice with EMC's due to fact that all provide net metering, some EMC's do solar buybacks, best practice would be to design a system made to offset about 30-50% of their current usage consumption and supplement the solar with a battery back up. Having a battery backup will ensure that you use some of the production that would've been exported to the grid with your home. Also, a way to take advantage of state and federal incentives, solar their consumption from the grid and save some money.

South Carolina

- **South Carolina Solar Tax Credit:** The 25% state solar tax credit is available for purchased rooftop solar panels in South Carolina, including installation. Max. amount: \$3,500 paid out each year. It has no expiration date, and any excess credit may be carried forward up to 10 years.
- **Santee Cooper Solar Rebate Program:** Eligible Santee Cooper customers may qualify to get cash incentives for every kilowatt (kW) of solar power installed.
- **Duke Energy Progress:** Customers of Duke Energy Progress can get a \$1.00 rebate for every watt (W) of solar power they install on their home or business. For an average 6-kilowatt (kW) system, that's an extra \$6,000 in your pocket to help cover the cost of going solar.
- **Santee Cooper:** Thanks to a new incentive program, Santee Cooper customers are eligible for a rebate of \$1.30/W of solar energy that they install on their roofs, up to \$5,200.
- **Net metering** is available for Duke Energy and Dominion Energy customers

North Carolina:

- **Duke Energy** offers rebates to North Carolina customers who want to install a solar panel system. For homeowners, the program offers a \$0.60/Watt rebate for systems up to 10 kilowatts. An average 6 kilowatt (kW) system would be eligible for a rebate of \$3,600.
- **State property tax exemption:** The value that solar adds to a property isn't included in property tax assessments thanks to this property tax exemption.
- **Net metering** is available for Dominion Energy and Duke Energy Customers. Research EMC regulations, Each EMC has its own policies regarding residential solar.

Virginia:

- **Net metering is** available for 3 utility companies in Virginia, Dominion Energy, Northern VA Electric Co-Op, Rappahannock Co-Op.
- Virginia has a law allowing localities to exempt or partially exempt solar from the property taxes residents pay. Note, however, that not all localities allow this exemption – currently, only 30 do. If yours doesn't, you may wish to petition your Board of Supervisors to approve an ordinance to allow it.

Michigan: Michigan residents can apply for the DG inflow/outflow solar net metering. Michigan had 1:1 net metering but now is transitioning to an inflow/outflow structure. State property tax exemption is also applicable in this state.

Pennsylvania:

- **Solar Renewable Energy Credits (SRECs):** Compensation per kilowatt-hour (kWh) produced by the system.⁸ (Based on market value)¹¹
- **Philadelphia Solar Rebate Program:** Philadelphia residents may qualify for a \$200 rebate for every kilowatt (kW) of solar power installed.
- **Net metering** is available in all utilities

Connecticut:

- **Property Tax Exemption for Renewable Energy Systems:** Property tax exemption on the added home value from the Connecticut solar array.
- **Sales and Use Tax Exemption for Solar Systems:** 6.35% home solar system state sales tax exemption.^{11,14}
- **Connecticut Green Bank Residential Solar Investment Program (RSIP):** For Leased Systems: Compensation of \$0.30 per kilowatt-hour (kWh) produced by the home solar power system. For Purchased Systems: Compensation of up to \$0.426 per installed watt. (Max. system size: 10 kilowatts (kW))⁸
- **Residential Solar Investment Program:** Administered by the Connecticut Green Bank, this rebate is worth \$0.463 per watt of solar installed (up to 10kW). That is, a homeowner who invests in a 5kW system would receive \$2,315 right off the bat.

New Hampshire:

- **Small PV systems program:** Any homeowner in New Hampshire with a solar system size of 10 kilowatts (kW) or less will qualify for the state's incentive program for small residential solar. The program pays \$0.20 per watt up to \$1,000 or half the cost of the system, whichever comes first.
- **Local property tax exemption:** Tax exempt from paying property taxes on the additional value solar adds to your home in the state of New Hampshire.

Maryland:

- **Solar Renewable Energy Credits (SRECs):** Compensation per kilowatt-hour (kWh) produced by the system. (Based on market value.)
- **Solar Energy System Property Tax Exemption:** Property tax exemption that excludes the added value of an installed solar panel system from the home's value for tax purposes.
- **Solar Panel System Sales Tax Exemption:** 6% home solar system state sales tax exemption.
- **Residential Clean Energy Rebate Program (R-CERP):** Marylanders who purchase and install a new residential solar power system may qualify for a \$1,000 rebate.

If you install a solar energy system, Maryland will pay you \$1,000. Just make sure your system is smaller than 20 kilowatts (kW), is located at your primary residence, and that your installer has the standard NABCEP certification. Maryland has set a renewable portfolio standard goal to produce 2.5 percent of its electricity from solar resources in 2020, and you can get paid to help. Under this program, you are granted one Maryland SREC for each megawatt-hour (MWh) of clean electricity your panels produce, which you can then sell in the SREC market.